

# CHINESE CABBAGE *Brassica rapa* var. *pekinensis*

A member of the Oriental brassica family, Chinese cabbage has a delicate cabbage taste and succulent texture and is excellent for use in stir-fries or eaten raw in salads. As long as you give it plenty of water, Chinese cabbage is an easy vegetable to grow and makes a good cut-and-come-again crop. It is also relatively fast-growing, so consider growing it before or between slower-growing vegetables such as turnips or parsnips.

|                  | SPRING | SUMMER | FALL | WINTER |
|------------------|--------|--------|------|--------|
| <b>SOW/PLANT</b> |        |        |      |        |
| <b>HARVEST</b>   |        |        |      |        |

## SOWING

Chinese cabbage needs very fertile soil in a sunny, sheltered position, so dig in plenty of well-rotted manure or compost in the fall before planting, or apply fertilizer.

Sow seed in late spring or early summer if sowing directly into the ground, since plants will try to bolt if sown outside earlier (bolt-resistant varieties are available). If you want to make an early start, sow under cover in module trays and transplant seedlings, when the risk of frost has passed.

Sow seed thinly at a depth of .75 in (2 cm) in rows 18 in (45 cm) apart. Once the seedlings are established, thin out to allow 12 in (30 cm) between plants.



**Keep the fast-growing crops well weeded.**

Chinese cabbage can be grown as a catch crop or intercropped with other plants since it is quick to grow and will be ready to harvest within eight to 10 weeks.

## CROP CARE

Keep crops well-weeded and make sure that they have plenty of water—like bok choy, Chinese cabbage has very short roots and a tendency to dry out.